

Etienne Fokou

Software Engineer | Cloud Infrastructure & Distributed Systems | Backend & Platform Engineering

Bellevue, WA | (678) 650-4245 | etienne56@gmail.com | <https://www.linkedin.com/in/efokou/>

Professional Summary:

Results-driven Software Engineer with 7+ years of experience designing, building, and maintaining scalable distributed systems and cloud infrastructure across enterprise environments. Proven track record at Microsoft and Aflac delivering automation solutions, improving system reliability, and optimizing CI/CD pipelines to accelerate software delivery. Experienced in cloud platforms including AWS, Azure, and Google Cloud, with hands-on expertise in containerization, microservices architecture, and infrastructure as code. Skilled in Python, Go, Bash, Java, C#, and JavaScript/Node.js with a strong foundation in incident management, capacity planning, and performance optimization. Adept at collaborating with cross-functional engineering and product teams to integrate reliability and scalability into the full software development lifecycle. Passionate about leveraging automation, observability, and modern DevOps practices to reduce toil, improve deployment frequency, and deliver high-quality software at scale.

Technical Skills & Tools:

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Go, Bash, Java, C#, JavaScript, Node.js, Shell Scripting
- **Cloud Platforms:** Amazon Web Services (AWS), Microsoft Azure, Google Cloud Platform (GCP), AWS ECS, AWS Proton, AWS Lambda, AWS CloudWatch
- **Containers & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, Amazon ECS, Microservices Architecture
- **Infrastructure as Code & Configuration Management:** Terraform, Ansible, AWS CloudFormation, Infrastructure as Code (IaC)
- **CI/CD & DevOps Tools:** GitHub Actions, Jenkins, GitOps, ArgoCD, Azure DevOps, Git
- **Monitoring, Observability & Logging:** Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana), AWS CloudWatch, PagerDuty
- **System & Software Engineering:** Distributed Systems, System Design, Microservices, REST APIs, Capacity Planning, Performance Optimization, High Availability, Fault Tolerance
- **Reliability & Incident Management:** Incident Response, Root Cause Analysis, Disaster Recovery, Business Continuity Planning, On-Call Operations, MTTR Reduction, SLOs, SLAs, RTO, RPO, Blameless Post-Mortems
- **Security & Compliance:** IAM Roles & Permissions, DevSecOps, Network Security, VPC Configuration, Load Testing, Penetration Testing
- **Collaboration & Methodology:** Agile, Scrum, Cross-functional Collaboration, Code Review, Technical Documentation, RACI Frameworks

Experience:

Senior Software Engineer

Gartner | July 2025 – Present

- Designing and developing scalable backend services and distributed systems supporting Gartner's enterprise research and data platforms serving thousands of global clients.
- Building and maintaining CI/CD pipelines using GitHub Actions and Jenkins, improving deployment frequency and reducing time-to-production for engineering teams.
- Implementing infrastructure as code using Terraform to provision and manage cloud resources across AWS and Azure, ensuring consistency, repeatability, and version-controlled infrastructure.
- Developing containerized microservices using Docker and Kubernetes, improving application portability, scalability, and resource utilization across production environments.
- Integrating observability and monitoring solutions using Prometheus, Grafana, and Datadog to proactively identify performance bottlenecks and reduce mean time to resolution (MTTR).
- Collaborating with cross-functional product and engineering teams to define technical requirements, conduct code reviews, and ensure high-quality software delivery aligned with business objectives.
- Participating in on-call rotations, leading incident response efforts, conducting blameless post-mortems, and implementing preventive measures to improve overall system reliability.
- Driving automation initiatives to eliminate manual toil, streamline operational workflows, and increase engineering team productivity across the software development lifecycle.

Software Engineer II

Microsoft | May 2022 – June 2025

- Designed, implemented, and maintained scalable cloud infrastructure supporting critical enterprise services on Azure,

ensuring high availability and fault tolerance across distributed systems.

- Developed automation tools in Python, Bash, and Go for monitoring, deployment, and incident response, reducing manual operational overhead and improving system reliability by streamlining repetitive workflows.
- Built and optimized CI/CD pipelines to accelerate software delivery, improving deployment frequency and reducing lead time for production releases across multiple engineering teams.
- Conducted capacity planning, performance analysis, and system tuning to optimize resource utilization and ensure consistent service performance under peak load conditions.
- Improved monitoring and alerting systems using cloud-native observability tools, proactively identifying and resolving potential issues before they impacted end users or business operations.
- Implemented and maintained disaster recovery and business continuity plans, ensuring systems met defined recovery time objectives (RTO) and recovery point objectives (RPO).
- Participated in on-call rotations contributing to incident response, root cause analysis, and resolution, driving down mean time to resolution (MTTR) across critical production services.
- Evaluated and recommended technical improvements to system architecture, tooling, and processes, enhancing overall platform reliability, developer productivity, and operational efficiency.

Systems Engineer

Aflac | August 2016 – May 2022

- Automated cluster creation, platform updates, and application upgrades for Docker, Jenkins, Akana, and other enterprise tools using Ansible playbooks, significantly reducing manual effort and configuration errors.
- Led proof of concept for cloud migration to AWS using AWS Proton, publishing environment templates for ECS clusters and service templates for ECS tasks, enabling serverless container deployments with no host management overhead.
- Designed and implemented self-service CI/CD pipeline capabilities enabling developers to independently build and deploy code, reducing infrastructure team overhead and accelerating time-to-market for new features.
- Authored RACI documentation and operational runbooks for IT support teams, streamlining call resolution processes, reducing average incident resolution time, and improving overall organizational productivity.
- Supported formal and informal test events including load testing, penetration testing, and infrastructure-driven activities to validate system performance, security posture, and reliability.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to evaluate emerging technologies and recommend infrastructure improvements aligned with business scalability and reliability objectives.

Projects:

Bus Ticket Reservation & Travel Booking Platform — Mapan

Tech Stack: Python, REST APIs, SQL, PostgreSQL, Mobile/Web Integration, Automated Testing

- Built backend API integrations supporting real-time ticket availability, booking confirmations, and payment processing across multiple transport providers.
- Developed automated testing and monitoring scripts for reservation workflows, reducing booking failures and improving transaction accuracy.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to optimize user experience and support scalable onboarding of additional transportation partners.

Cloud Infrastructure Automation & CI/CD Pipeline Optimization

Tech Stack: Terraform, Ansible, AWS ECS, Docker, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Python, Bash

- Automated cloud infrastructure provisioning using Terraform and Ansible, reducing manual setup time and ensuring consistent version-controlled deployments.
- Built and optimized CI/CD pipelines using Jenkins and GitHub Actions, automating build, test, and deployment workflows across multiple engineering teams.

Distributed System Monitoring & Observability

Tech Stack: Prometheus, Grafana, Datadog, ELK Stack, AWS CloudWatch, PagerDuty

- Implemented centralized observability platform using Prometheus and Grafana, reducing mean time to detection (MTTD) and resolution (MTTR) across critical production services.
- Built log aggregation pipelines using ELK Stack and AWS CloudWatch, centralizing logging across distributed microservices and accelerating root cause analysis.

Education:

- **Bachelor of Science in Computer Science**
Kennesaw State University | Kennesaw, GA | 2016